

SNIPPETS

TCS to increase China staff to 5000

Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) is planning to more than quadruple its workforce in China over the next five years to tap rising demand for outsourcing services in the country. It will increase its China staff to 5000 by 2014 from 1100 currently. TCS is looking to reduce its dependence on the US and Europe and wants to increase its presence in growing markets such as Asia Pacific, the Middle East and Africa.

Sun Microsystems slashes 3000 jobs

Sun Microsystems is laying off 3000 jobs over the next 12 months because of the delay in its takeover by the US business software firm Oracle. The move will result in charges between \$75 million and \$125 million over the next several quarters. The \$7.4 billion deal for Sun is now on hold pending approval by European regulators.

Tata-Quippo to buy Aircel's 12,000 towers

Tata-Quippo, the telecom tower venture between the Tatas and Kolkata-based Kanoria's Srei group, is in advanced stages of negotiations with New York-based private equity fund Apollo Management to finance acquisition of Aircel's tower assets.

Accenture, Tieto and Wipro. According to the company, the transition of these services is expected to be finalised in February 2010.

Accenture will take over the global responsibility for providing application management services for IT applications used in human resources, finance and control and Nokia Siemens Networks' company wide corporate tools and platforms.

Tieto will take over the global responsibility for providing application management services for R&D related applications and care-related applications.

Wipro will take over the global responsibility for providing application management services for SAP, delivery, marketing and sales and product data management applications.

Acer replaces Dell as No. 2 PC maker

Taiwan's Acer has surpassed Dell to capture the world's second position as PC maker in the third quarter of 2009. Acer outperformed the market in virtually all regions and showed a growth of 25.6 per cent. However, HP maintained its top slot, growing 9.3 per cent from last year. Dell experienced a decline of 8.4 per cent. Lenovo and Toshiba grabbed the fourth and fifth positions, respectively.

Panasonic, Renesas to develop 32nm process technologies

Panasonic Corporation and Renesas Technology will jointly develop SoC process technologies at the Renesas Naka site and will start operation of their 28 to 32nm process development line installed at the site.

In the development line at the Naka site, the two companies have installed new production equipment in addition to having transferred part of the development line equipment from the Renesas Kitatami site. The companies are aiming at achieving a smooth transition to mass production, reducing development costs and time.

LG Group to merge three telecom units

South Korea's LG Group plans to go ahead with a long-considered merger of its three telecom units—mobile carrier LG Telecom, fixed-line operator LG Dacom and broadband firm LG Powercom.

A merger was seen as a necessary step for LG to compete with bigger telecom rivals like KT Corp. and SK Telecom as operators in the saturated Korean market focus on looking at customers through products bundling mobile, fixed-line and Internet services.

Large participation at China Sourcing Fairs

Global Sources opened its largest-ever electronics trade shows at AsiaWorld-Expo, Hong Kong on October 12, 2009. The China Sourcing Fairs: Electronics and Components and Security Products featured 3069 booths from 12 countries.

A large number of manufacturers from mainland China showcased their products in Asia, with over 2350 booths from China alone. Hong Kong and Taiwan suppliers were also well represented with over 600 booths. Exhibitors from South Korea, the US, Italy, Israel, Australia, Germany, the Philippines, Singapore and Malaysia also took part in the fairs.

According to Sarah Benecke, executive director, Global Sources, "Suppliers have realised that as the global economy starts to improve, they need to increase their marketing efforts to win orders and meet new buyers. As a result, we are seeing greater participation in our electronics shows."

More than 40,000 buyers pre-registered for the China Sourcing Fairs, including buyers from North America and Western Europe as well as new buyers from Russia, South America, India and the Middle East. Best Buy, EPSON, Kodak, LG Sourcing, Li & Fung, Microsoft, Motorola, Nokia, Philips, Samsung, Tesco and Toshiba were amongst the big names who attended the event.

New SIPLACE factory based on lean production principles

Siemens Electronics Assembly Systems (SEAS) has opened its new factory in Munich. The new factory was designed in accordance with the latest lean production principles.

Despite its increased output and flexible production capacity, the production area takes up less than 20 per cent of the floor space. At the same time, the lead time from the start of the production to shipping a finished machine could be reduced to mere 10 days, a 60 per cent cut down.